**Dear Reader**: This is a special author-annotated version of a paper that I published in EMNLP 2026. See the companion notes starting on page nine for overall remarks, commentary that pairs with the highlighted text, and a timeline of how this paper came together. For more about this paper, visit https://shomir.net/nlpmw. – **Shomir Wilson**

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# NLP Meets the World: Toward Improving Conversations With News Media About Natural Language Processing Research

**Shomir Wilson**
Department of Human-Centered Computing and Social Informatics
College of Information Sciences and Technology
Pennsylvania State University
shomir@psu.edu

## Abstract

Recent advances in large language models (LLMs) have rapidly increased the public's interest in natural language processing (NLP). This attention is reflected by news outlets inviting NLP researchers to share their knowledge and views with public audiences. Recognizing the opportunities for the research field and for individual researchers, this paper shares recommendations for speaking with news media about NLP's capabilities and limitations. Drawing on the topical structure of research communication frameworks published by the US National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine and the European Union's QUEST project, recommendations are provided for three field-appropriate communication challenges: cognitive terminology, unsustainable expectations, and ethical failures. Published NLP research and popular news coverage are cited to provide examples. The recommendations promote effective, transparent communication with the general public about NLP, in order to strengthen public understanding and encourage support for research.

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## Note

*Because of the subject matter, this paper cites a variety of types of sources, including news articles, unpublished essays, preprints, and whitepapers. Citations and references marked with an asterisk (i.e., *) represent sources that are not known to be peer-reviewed.*

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## 1 Introduction

Public communication is a vital task for the natural language processing (NLP) research community, which faces a unique confluence of circumstances. Interest in LLMs has led news venues to publish non-technical explanations of how LLMs work (Roose, 2023*; Clarke et al., 2023*), predictions about LLMs' future abilities (Waters, 2025*), explorations of LLMs' social biases (Rogers, 2025*), and concerns about their impacts on employment (Hayes, 2025*). Journalists also have interviewed researchers who critique claims about artificial general intelligence (AGI) (Heikkilä, 2025*; Piquard, 2024*). Within scholarly literature, LLMs are sometimes claimed to be an existential threat to humanity (Tait and Bensemann, 2024; Grozdanoff, 2023), while some critique the plausibility or meaning of AGI (Blili-Hamelin et al., 2025; Mueller, 2024*). Regardless of stance, these activities reflect an unprecedented surge of public attention.

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The public discussion of NLP extends into culture and language, as NLP researchers contend with portrayals of AI in science fiction (Osawa et al., 2022) and ambiguity over cognitive terms such as *reason* and *understand* (Mitchell and Krakauer, 2023). While research communication is a challenging task for many scholarly disciplines (Simis et al., 2016), little support is available for the acute challenges that NLP researchers currently face. This gap in support contrasts with the importance of research communication: it encourages public support for research funding, influences public policy, and engages students who may become future researchers.

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This paper serves as a referenceable set of recommendations for NLP researchers interacting with news media, including interviewing with journalists and publishing commentary. It derives thematic and structural inspiration from research communication frameworks published by the US National Academies of Sciences, Engineering, and Medicine (2017*) and the European Union's QUEST project (2020*). Their guidance is translated into three challenges for communicating NLP research: *cognitive terminology* (§3), *unsustainable expectations* (§4), and *ethical failures* (§5). Rather than replacing existing guidance (as reviewed in §2), this paper fills a notable gap by

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attending to the contemporary challenges specifically relevant to NLP.

## 2 Background and Related Work

The US National Academies created a framework for exploring the task of research communication (2017*), but its guidance is intentionally broad (i.e., for all disciplines at once). This paper translates the three core challenges in their framework into challenges for NLP: *the complexities of communicating science* (cognitive terminology, §3), *communicating science in a complex, competitive communication environment* (unsustainable expectations, §4), and *the nature of science-related public controversies* (ethical failures, §5). Similarly, the European Union-funded QUEST (QUality and Effectiveness in Science and Technology communication) project identified 12 quality indicators for science communication and clustered them into three themes (QUEST Project, 2020*). Their themes are aligned with the same challenges: *presentation* (cognitive terminology), *connection* (unsustainable expectations), and *trustworthiness* (ethical failures). No such mapping or guidance can be comprehensive, which is discussed further in Limitations, but these prior frameworks lend focus and structure to the present work.

Prior published literature on research communication provides little guidance tailored to NLP (i.e., in contrast with general guidance for researchers in any discipline). Notably, Hudson and Franklin (2023*) observe that using performance figures to describe explainable AI research alienates public audiences. A series of AAAI tutorials have focused on science communication (e.g., Smith (2025)), but their reach and accessibility differ from a published paper. Wyrich and Wagner (2023) designed a course-based exercise for computer science undergraduates to practice communicating software engineering research, but they focus on describing the exercise itself. Beyond computing, Fontaine et al. (2019) surveyed the literature on public communication by researchers within the health sciences. They noted wide use of social media and proposed a typology of strategies. These include minimizing the use of jargon, encouraging public discussion, and making information actionable, among others. Kuncel and Rigdon (2013*) address science communication for psychology, with a focus on making statistical methods understandable.

Finally, this paper follows an established practice of NLP conference papers that reflect on community challenges. Examples include Rogers and Augenstein's recommendations for improving peer review (2020), Blodgett et al.'s critique of how *bias* is discussed (2020), and Mosbach et al.'s discussion of interpretability research (2024).

## 3 Cognitive Terminology

NLP researchers often describe their work using terms that public audiences associate with cognition, and the cognitive claims those terms imply might be intended or unintentional. Additionally, the research community lacks an agreed-upon stance on some cognitive claims, partly because of a lack of agreement for what they mean (Bender and Koller, 2020). These conditions are difficult for non-experts to navigate, limiting their abilities to interpret or support NLP research. This section illustrates with terms used in published research.

### 3.1 It's Complicated: NLP's Relationship With Cognitive Terms[1]

Terms with cognitive implications (among their other implications) have a long history in NLP, and some are widely interpreted by researchers as non-cognitive. *Predict*, for example, has been associated with text classification at least as early as the 1990s (Riloff and Lehnert, 1992; Liddy et al., 1994) and possibly earlier. *Read* also has a long history (Srihari, 1992; Govindan and Shivaprasad, 1990). *Learn* (as in *machine learning*) originates from a 1959 paper by Arthur Samuel about programs that play the game of checkers (Samuel, 1959; Foote, 2021*). However, a non-expert may associate all three of those terms with the ability to *think* or *understand*, broadly without definitions. Observe that "a *human* must understand to predict" is intuitively reasonable, but several papers cited in §1 show that "a *language model* must understand to predict" is not universally agreed upon by the NLP research community.

LLMs' capabilities and limitations have amplified attention to cognitive terms. *Hallucinate* is widely used by the research community (Huang et al., 2025), even if a precise meaning is not agreed upon (Narayanan Venkit et al., 2024). However, the relevance of *understand*, *reason*, and *think* are controversial (Bender and Koller, 2020; Shojaee et al.,

[1]Note this manuscript does not evaluate cognitive claims about LLMs. Instead, it shows how the NLP research community uses cognitive terms differently from the general public, including examples that predate LLMs.

2025*). Again, the relationships between these terms within NLP may not match the relationships intuited by an outside audience. For example, a human who is *hallucinating* is presumably *thinking* (albeit aberratively), but a *hallucinating* LLM is not agreed upon by the research community to be *thinking*. Additionally, researchers in the health sciences have criticized using *hallucinate* to refer to LLM behavior as inappropriate and misleading (Smith et al., 2023; Østergaard and Nielbo, 2023).

17 A further complication occurs when arguments against LLMs' cognitive abilities nominally exclude humans from having those same abilities. For example, Shojaee et al. (2025*) argue that language reasoning models (LRMs, closely related to LLMs) cannot *think* because of "a complete accuracy collapse" for complex tasks. The human brain also has task complexity limits (Marois and Ivanoff, 2005), but in contrast with LLMs, the human brain is widely recognized as capable of *thinking*.

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### 3.2 Recommendations

NLP researchers speaking to the public should provide scope for cognitive terms they use. Given the above obstacles, it is helpful to tell an audience what terms such as *predict* or *reason* mean in a context. If a non-cognitive term can replace a cognitive one, that substitution may provide greater clarity. When benchmarks are relevant, describing them can demystify how a cognitive or quasi-cognitive claim is justified. A general goal is to avoid the possibility of unintended cognitive implications for LLMs or other human language technologies.

19 NLP researchers should balance correcting cognitive misconceptions about LLMs with tolerating a general audience's verbal shorthand and metaphor. Humans apply cognitive anthropomorphism to a variety of objects (Boyer, 1996) such as lamps and umbrellas (Edwards and Shafer, 2022), and LLMs display far more sophisticated behavior than those

20 objects. When cognitive terms surface in discussions about LLMs, a diplomatic strategy is to point out the verbal shorthand or metaphor, acknowledge its naturalness, and explain the actual limitations of the technology. This strategy validates a non-expert's experiences with technology while illuminating how cognitive terms can mislead.

## 4 Unsustainable Expectations

21 Predictions of the impacts of LLMs include radical improvements in biology, neuroscience, economic development, and human welfare, and the onset of global peace (Amodei, 2024*). The possibility of an "AI bubble"[2] (i.e., an unsustainable level of public interest in AI that exceeds its capabilities) is widely acknowledged (Horowitch, 2025*; Press, 2025*). A bubble implies short-term benefits, such as publicity and abundant resources. However, its collapse—implied by the metaphor—creates harm through an unpredictably sharp decline in resources. This section provides examples from the history of AI and recommendations for how NLP researchers can encourage realistic expectations about the field.

### 4.1 Remembering AI Winters

Multiple AI winters are said to have occurred: Roger Schank and Marvin Minsky referred to one in the 1970s (Crevier, 1993*), and James Hendler referred to one in the 1980s (Hendler, 2008*). This section uses Hendler's more recent perspective to structure the discussion.

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Hendler described a confluence of three conditions that led to the AI winter of the 1980s. The first was a decrease in government funding for AI research in the 1970s, specifically in the USA, which dominated AI research at the time. He argues the impact was delayed by five to ten years, as already-approved projects ran their course. For the rationale of the cuts, Hendler quotes a 1973 report by James Lighthill in the United Kingdom that concluded "in no part of the field have discoveries made so far produced the major impact that was then promised." (Lighthill et al., 1973*)

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The second condition was an erosion of recognition for AI's successes. Hendler argues that expert systems (Buchanan and Smith, 1988), which were successful in industry, were "disowned" by AI researchers in favor of topics where less progress had been made. The third condition was the rapid democratization of hardware needed to run AI models, in the sense that the hardware became dramatically cheaper and easier to own, thus disrupting sociotechnical power structures within research (Hendler, 2008*).

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These conditions require some subjectivity to assess, making it difficult to firmly state whether they exist now or will appear in the near future. However, there are discernible lessons in them for how NLP researchers communicate their work.

[2]There exists a lack of agreement on the distinction between contemporary AI and NLP, with some common ground and some differences. To avoid misattribution, this paper uses "AI" for topics where the term prevails in popular discussion.

### 4.2 Recommendations

For the NLP research community as a whole, the downsides of setting realistic expectations are modest when compared to the downsides of a sudden collapse in public interest. At the individual level, one researcher's careful management of expectations when speaking about their work is unlikely to change public perception of the field, but strategies exist that fulfill that goal while creating individual benefit as well. Such a strategy is described below.

25 Public engagement is an opportunity to support recognition of NLP applications that may have been inadvertently "disowned" (borrowing Hendler's description) for their success. NLP played a formative role in early search engines (Schwartz, 1998) and enabled early spam detection (Cormack, 2008). Optical character recognition made a wealth of pre-digital texts searchable (Hill and Hengchen, 2019), and authorship identification solved historical mysteries (Tweedie et al., 1996). Those examples and others show that NLP can enable *calm technologies*, supporting human work rather than monopolizing human attention (Weiser and Brown, 1996). They also may serve as an antidote to hype by illustrating that research products need time to mature. Dialog systems are a strong public-facing example of the long road to practical use: early systems such as 26 Eliza (Weizenbaum, 1966) are distant ancestors of modern virtual assistants, such as Amazon Alexa, Siri, and Google Assistant.

## 5 Ethical Failures

Ethically dubious practices are known to exist within the NLP research community, and external to it, problematic NLP applications also exist. Both are obstacles to how NLP research is received by a public audience. This section gives examples of relevant ethical failures and provides suggestions for how NLP researchers can speak frankly and constructively when called upon to discuss them.

### 5.1 Reckoning With Problematic NLP

Research institutions in many countries have procedures for reviewing experimental protocols that involve human subjects. However, sometimes an experiment complies with requirements while violating ethical norms, or researchers fail to seek approval. A recent example is an experiment in which researchers studied the persuasiveness of an LLM-powered chatbot by covertly deploying it on the Reddit forum *r/changemyview*[3], concealing that it was an LLM. When forum moderators were informed about the deception, they expressed shock, asked for an apology from the university, and requested that the research not be published (O'Grady, 2025). 27 The experiment also reflects a mismatch between researchers' expectations and a studied population's expectations for ethical uses of NLP. Another example of mismatched ethical expectations is the use of de-identified conversation data from Crisis Text Line, a free nonprofit service for people in crisis in the US, by a for-profit company. Although users of Crisis Text Line were provided with a link to terms of service, informing them how their data could be shared, public backlash led to the termination of the data sharing agreement (Eysenbach, 2025).

28 A comprehensive list of ethical failures or misuses of NLP is impractical, but examples are readily available. LLMs have been used to generate disinformation, potentially manipulating geopolitics (Mejias and Vokuev, 2017). Chatbots have demonstrated the capacity to respond harmfully in conversations with people suffering from mental illness (Coghlan et al., 2023), and more broadly, LLMs' sociodemographic biases have been shown to harm individuals from minoritized groups (Ghosh et al., 2024). The broad-based collection of training data for LLMs raises privacy concerns and intellectual property concerns (Novelli et al., 2024). NLP and computing security are increasingly intertwined, obligating NLP researchers to learn more about the nuanced ethics of security research (Lent et al., 2025). LLM-assisted writing has been claimed to produce "cognitive debt" and reduce critical thinking (Kosmyna et al., 2025*). LLM training and usage consume significant resources, raising questions about environmental sustainability (Kogkalidis and Chatzikyriakidis, 2025). Finally, NLP research is vulnerable to distortion by monied interests, potentially influencing individual researchers and entire institutions (Abdalla and Abdalla, 2021).

29 The above harms and others receive public attention, to the extent that a 2023 Pew Research survey found 52% of Americans were more concerned than excited about AI in their daily lives (Faverio and Tyson, 2023*). This level of concern is demonstrably relevant to NLP researchers.

[3] https://www.reddit.com/r/changemyview/

### 5.2 Recommendations

Several popular news articles cited in this paper show that NLP researchers are called upon to discuss problematic uses of NLP. Open dialog about these problems is obligatory and familiar as part of open science, but further steps can help to sustain public support. Researchers speaking with the general public about problematic NLP should be prepared to explain what should have been done differently to achieve the same goals, or why the goals never should have been undertaken. Public interaction is also an opportunity to point to research directly aimed at solving ethical issues in NLP, showing how human-centered research is a valuable part of the community. Such research is a marked contrast with a hypothetical public image of AI research as solely focused on computation.

Within the research community, researchers can lay the groundwork for strong public support by recognizing that research that critiques NLP fully belongs in the community. Such research does not necessarily create human language technologies, but it guides their ethical development. This inclusion also encourages grounding NLP research in human benefit, which demonstrates responsiveness to the concerns of the general public.

## 6 Conclusion

Beyond this paper, other strategies are possible for encouraging NLP researchers to engage productively with news media. Among them are holding media training sessions at conferences and developing curricular modules for students to learn about research communication. A multi-pronged strategy, including these activities or others, has the greatest potential to reach a wide audience of researchers.

Public attention to NLP research comes with benefits, obstacles, and responsibilities. This paper presented recommendations to help NLP researchers communicate effectively with the public, focusing on obstacles that are distinctive to our research community. It drew upon a variety of sources to illustrate those obstacles and how to navigate them, for the prosperity of individual researchers and for the research community at large.

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## Limitations

A comprehensive guide to research communication, examining all possible scenarios, is infeasible. Instead, this manuscript augments existing discipline-nonspecific guides to focus on NLP. In §1 and §2 readers are reminded of that, and in §2 more sources are cited for the reader to consult. Additionally, the complexity and subjectivity of research communication mean that no one guide (or even the union of all guides) will be comprehensive for the problems researchers face. However, other fields appear to find research communication guides helpful, as shown by their acceptance for publication, the citations to them, and reflections on them (de Bruin and Bostrom, 2013).

NLP researchers may face public communication challenges not covered by this paper's guidance. This paper identifies challenges of particular concern by interpreting established research communication frameworks, but other challenges may exist. The subjective nature of the topic space obviates covering it in an exhaustive way, but sharing guidance grounded in recognized prior frameworks (as this manuscript does) is deemed more likely to lead to positive outcomes than the relative lack of guidance in the status quo.

## Ethical Considerations

This paper is reflective in purpose and does not represent experiments, and its ethical ramifications are limited to the guidance it provides. Existing research communication frameworks and other cited literature provide evidence that the topics in this manuscript are relevant and have received little or no prior attention for NLP. The reader is encouraged to consult additional guidance as necessary.

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# NLP Meets the World: Companion Notes

**Shomir Wilson**

## Remarks

I'm sharing some behind-the-scenes notes about this paper to explain why I wrote it, how it came together, and how reviewers' comments improved it. My motivation for these notes is to benefit other researchers, especially students who are new to writing papers for publication. I'm also motivated by an enjoyment of explaining the hidden systems of academia and research. You can read more of my academic guidance and experience reports at https://shomir.net/advice.

As a Ph.D. student, my first paper submission also was a reflection paper. I submitted it to a small conference—Commonsense 2009—and it received one very enthusiastic review and two very negative ones; it was rejected. After that I avoided writing reflection papers for a long time, and getting this paper accepted to EMNLP is, in a way, the conclusion of a 17-year story arc. It's also the most unusual paper I've submitted to an NLP conference: it contains no algorithms, experiments, data, or math. It's readable by a general audience.

This enhanced version of the paper lives at https://shomir.net/nlpmw, where you can also find a link to the published version on ACL Anthology. Remember the published version is appropriate for citing and referencing, not this one, unless you're specifically referring to these companion notes.

Below is the commentary that pairs with the highlighted text. I think research writing can have depth and nuance, and although it's a paper with a sincere message, these callout notes also reveal some metatextual humor. After that is a timeline that shows the sequence of events that led to this paper's acceptance by EMNLP.

## Commentary

**1** I wrote this precolon as an allusion to a 1990s TV show called "Boy Meets World", which I never watched. Conveniently, readers in 2026 might know the similarly-titled Netflix series "Earle Meets World", which I've also never watched.

**2** The observations in this paper are broadly applicable to AI, but I targeted NLP to appeal to EMNLP reviewers.

**3** "For individual researchers" is an important nuance here: the interests of the NLP research community as a whole are connected to the interests of researchers within it. Some competition is inevitable in research, but if you're talking with news media then you're probably experiencing success. It's a time when supporting other people is easy and benefits both you and them.

**4** The first submission of this manuscript instead addressed improving conversations "with the public", but a reviewer criticized that as too vague.

**5** A reviewer suggested adding a visual distinction between citations to research and citations to news articles. In practice that distinction leaves out some sources, and instead I marked sources that weren't peer reviewed (to the best of my knowledge). Note some citations to non-peer reviewed sources still receive respect from the research community, such as the two research communication frameworks this manuscript builds upon.

**6** I avoid evaluating this claim (and many others) in this manuscript, but it's among the boldest claims I've ever paraphrased or quoted in a published paper.

**7** Three of my favorite under-appreciated older movies that portray anxieties about AI: (1) *Colossus: The Forbin Project* (1970), in which a supercomputer enacts an agenda of totalitarian world rule through control of nuclear weapons; (2) *Electric Dreams* (1984), in which young man's personal computer becomes sentient and a romantic rivalry ensues; and (3) *A. I. Artificial Intelligence* (2001), in which a robotic child goes on a quest to become human to earn a mother's love.

**8** All AI and NLP researchers are diplomats for their research communities, whether they're high schoolers talking with their parents or distinguished professors on live TV.

**9** "Dear reader, I know this is a strange paper, but could you cite it?"

**10** Connecting to these frameworks was the biggest difference between this manuscript and the first submission. Reviewers wanted evidence that the particular challenges I chose were meaningful.

11 This is the *section sign* (look it up in Wikipedia), and it's an underused space-saver in NLP papers.

12 I'd be glad to see (and even speak at) a science communication tutorial at an ACL event.

13 "Dear reviewer, conferences have published strange papers like this before. It's OK!"

14 A reviewer of the first version of this manuscript misunderstood §3.1 as supporting or refuting cognitive claims about LLMs, which it doesn't. I added a footnote to make that lack of stance explicit. This section broadly reflects my interests in this area, which are less about what constitutes LLMs "thinking" or "understanding" and more about the consistency or inconsistency of claims using these terms.

15 In other words: imagine two networks of entailments between word meanings, one representing NLP researchers' notions and the other representing the general public's notions. It's easy to assume the networks are identical, but they aren't. This is a graph isomorphism argument, though I didn't realize it when I wrote it.

16 This is one of a couple self-citations that appear in the paper. Junior researchers sometimes doubt whether it's OK to self-cite in a manuscript they will submit for double-blind review. It's actually fine if you remember to refer to your prior publications in the third person, as you would anyone else's work.

17 I originally wrote this observation in a social media post, and then I wanted to write an entire paper about it, but it wasn't enough. The idea of writing a paper with advice on research communication came shortly after.

18 Incredibly, this felt necessary to say. It doubles as dry wit.

19 I've occasionally heard NLP researchers argue against using cognitive terms for LLM behavior and then, a few minutes later, use them for that. I think we (researchers or anyone discussing AI) need to acknowledge the naturalness of metaphor while being fully aware of its limitations.

20 Be supportive and sympathetic even ("I know, it's easy to slip into talking about LLMs as *thinking*"), but make sure people understand the limitations of the language we use.

21 "[R]adical improvements" and "global peace": these claims reflect the unprecedented public attention to AI and NLP. Note that the cited Amodei essay received lots of press coverage, making it appropriate to mention.

22 Very rarely are students in my classes familiar with the AI winters before I introduce them. It's history we should learn from rather than repeating.

23 Apropos remembering AI history, this quote from the Lighthill Report remains remarkably prescient of contemporary critiques of AI.

24 There's an old saying that *AI* is a term for computing-related things that don't work well yet. This is a corollary to that claim.

25 NLP research has accomplished some great things. Remembering that is good for research community morale, not just research communication.

26 If you've never used Eliza, which is widely recognized as the first chatbot, try an online demo of it. After using it, consider how easy it is to anthropomorphize a chatbot that's nearly equivalent to a hundred-sided die with sentences on its sides.

27 This sentence was the direct result of a reviewer comment. Researchers' ethics aren't necessarily absent in situations like this; sometimes they're just different (and the researchers are unaware of the difference).

28 The failures in this paragraph came to mind more easily than successes. While the failures deserve attention, I sometimes think the NLP research community forgets how much it's accomplished.

29 This reflects what I've noticed in casual conversations about AI with people outside of computing research or practice. They often have a vague, worried question that resembles "Do you think AI is good?" or "Is AI harming humanity?" Questions like those reveal the opacity of AI to a general audience, as if AI is one thing instead of many.

30 Human-centered NLP research deserves more promotion to the public, for its impact and also for its value toward engaging public goodwill.

31 "Dear reviewer, accept this paper!"

32 Many PhD programs require a "how to do research" class, and I think research communication to the public is a topic that belongs in it. The relevance goes beyond talking with reporters; junior researchers often struggle to communicate their work even to other researchers in the same area.

33 There are limits to what a researcher can do to promote their work. Thanks to these profession-

als for the opportunities they've created for me to speak with news media about AI and NLP.

34 NSF awardees, remember to do this.

35 "Dear reviewer, this paper existing is better than this paper not existing, right?"

## Timeline

Briefly, I submitted the manuscript twice to ACL Rolling Review and committed it three times to conferences. The first two commitments were declined and the third was accepted.

**June 8, 2025**: I posted on social media some thoughts about using analytic philosophy to evaluate the language used in cognitive claims about LLMs' abilities. Soon afterward I began thinking about expanding the ideas into a publishable paper.

**June 15, 2025**: I began writing the paper, but I realized that I didn't have enough to say about the initial topic. I decided to write more broadly about the challenges of communicating NLP research to the general public.

**July 14, 2025**: I submitted the manuscript to ACL Rolling Review well ahead of the July 28 deadline. I had overestimated the time I needed to write.

**September 2025**: The reviews released for the author response period. The paper received overall scores of 2, 4, and 1.5. (ACL Rolling Review's scale for overall scores is 1–5, with 5 being the strongest.) The reviews contained some helpful suggestions, but the one with the lowest score contained a provocative comment about race and gender, which I reported to the metareveiwer. The metareviewer assigned the paper an overall assessment of 4.

**October 3, 2025**: I committed the paper plus reviews to IJCNLP-AACL 2025.

**October 25, 2025**: IJCNLP-AACL declined it.

**March 7, 2026**: I committed the paper plus reviews to ACL 2026.

**April 7, 2026**: ACL declined it.

**May 17, 2026**: Having made substantial changes to the paper, I submitted a revision to ACL Rolling Review. I requested different reviewers but the same metareviewer.

**July 2026**: The reviews released for the author response period, and the paper received overall scores of 4, 2.5, and 4. The 2.5 review spoke positively of the paper and listed some "minor edits". I replied to that review, agreeing with most of the edits point-by-point, and remarked that the overall score seemed low compared to their criticisms. The reviewer raised it to 4. The metareviewer gave the paper an overall score of 4.5.

**August 1, 2026**: I committed the paper plus reviews to EMNLP 2026.

**August 21, 2026**: EMNLP accepted the paper.